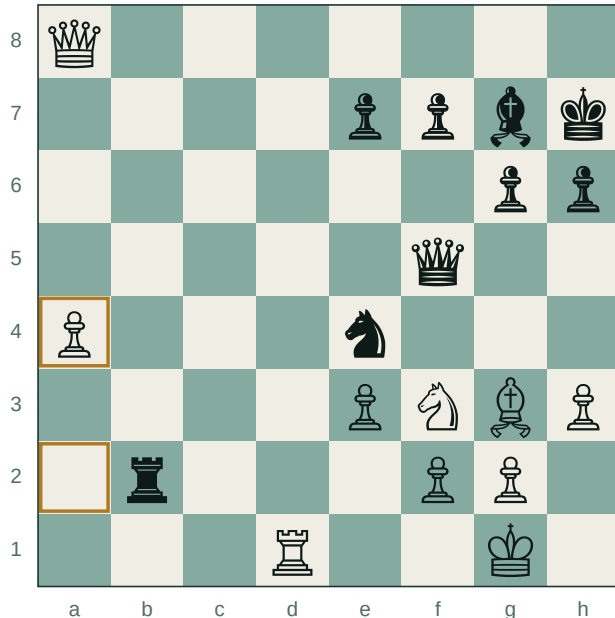


Clearance tactics: Black, move 31

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 31.a4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...Nxg3 32. fxg3 Qc2

31...Nxg3 The knight captures the bishop on g3. Recorded reply: **32.fxg3**.

32...Qc2 The queen moves from f5 to c2.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +0:** the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on a8 and rook on d1. Check for tactical protection.